

Radical Love

Participant Workbook



Radical Love ~ The Choice for Love

What does the voice of fear
whisper to you?

Fear speaks to you
in logic and reason. It assumes
the language of love itself

Fear tells you "I want to make you
safe" Love says, "you are safe."

Fear says,
"Give me symbols.
Give me frozen images.
Give me something
I can rely on."

Loving truth says,
"Only give me
this moment."

Fear would walk you
on a narrow path
promising to take you
where you want to go.

Love says,
"Open your arms
and fly with me."



Every moment of your life
You are offered the opportunity
To choose-
Love or fear,

To tread the earth
Or to soar the heaven



Introduction

What is your deepest desire in this program? Please write your first response without editing.

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**B
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While in the womb, we experienced sensations. Along with the sensations, thought streams, values, and emotions were transmitted and absorbed by us. Although they didn't mean anything to us yet, they were the seeds of our conditioned mind.

1. We have a sensation. Until we learn the word "I", all experiences are sensations.
2. We call our experiences the same names our parents did.
3. We put our parents values on these experiences (good or bad). We can't help it; it's just what is transmitted. If we had many differences with our parents we may take on the opposite beliefs that our parents did.
4. We dress our experiences with a story about why we are having them.



Notes

Birth to Now

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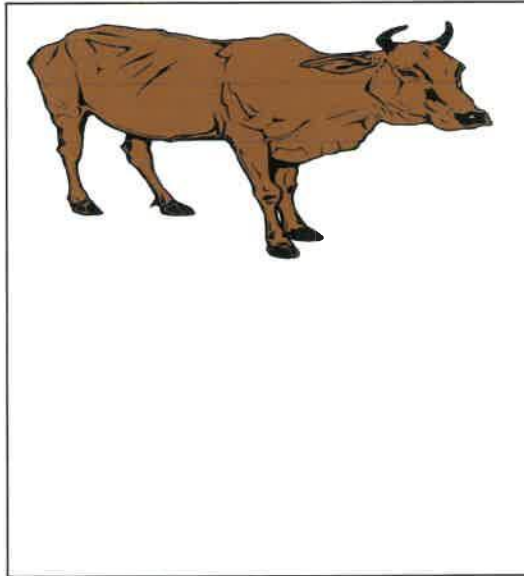
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Belief and Sacred Cows

Anger is Bad



Happy is Good

What Emotions Are

fundamental aspects
Emotions are simply waves of energy that help define our unique relationship with life. We can think of ourselves as radio receivers with many different stations. Each station has a different frequency that attracts emotion. *Energy waves*

Energy as per with by. culture/denied
Emotions exist both inside and outside of us simultaneously. When an external stimulus occurs that resonates with an emotional state inside of us, we respond based on our history. Sometimes, the wave passes through us as if we are transparent, other times, they stick to us and we react to them. *our note speed and flow of our emotions*

What happens to those emotions? Do they stay inside us? All emotions eventually move through us as long as we are willing to experience them fully.



Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue or grey ruling lines, typical of notebook paper. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Simulated The Reactive Self



Simulated

The ~~Reactive~~ Self is the "normal" way we learned how to be in our family. It includes all the ways we learned to ^{respond} ~~act~~ in childhood when our feelings and thoughts were not received by our families, ~~our~~ ^{experiences} teachers, ~~our~~ ^{opportunities} clergy or anyone in authority. If we didn't leave home, we might not even think about

people
this We might continue to have the same patterns, thoughts, feelings, and points of view of our childhood. *In fact we do have some of those. We may even say, "That's just the way we are!"*

So, what is so important about our ~~Reactive~~ *Simulated* Self? We have an old response to something—so what? We think we are feeling one thing and are really feeling something else—what difference does it make? We blame somebody or something for what we are feeling—is this so unusual? *Doesn't everyone interpret their experience? Is it not what makes us unique, interesting, special?*

Thinking
flaring We all know what it is like to blame someone or something for what we are feeling. Many of us are ~~not aware~~ *unaware* of what we are feeling at different times, and respond to situations that are happening NOW just the way we did ten, twenty or thirty, or even 60 years ago. So, what's the problem?

There can be a problem
~~We are at a disadvantage~~ when we are unaware of the effect of our behavior on ourselves and those around us. Our ability to assess present situations and relationships ~~when in reaction is~~ *becomes* impaired and keeps us ~~perpetuating~~ *trapped* in old patterns that may seriously limit us in realizing our heart's desire. We may be making decisions that we believe are based on rational thinking and logic, when in fact, we are being controlled by ~~fixed~~ *reified* emotions trapped in our cells. There is nothing "wrong" or "bad" with any of it. Yet, ~~reactive states prevent us from living in an openhearted way.~~ *we feel unable to*

unaware of who & what we really are
When we live ~~our lives~~ *unaware* from our reactions, our conditioning, we can be sure that our futures will be the same as our past.

Feelings not Experienced...



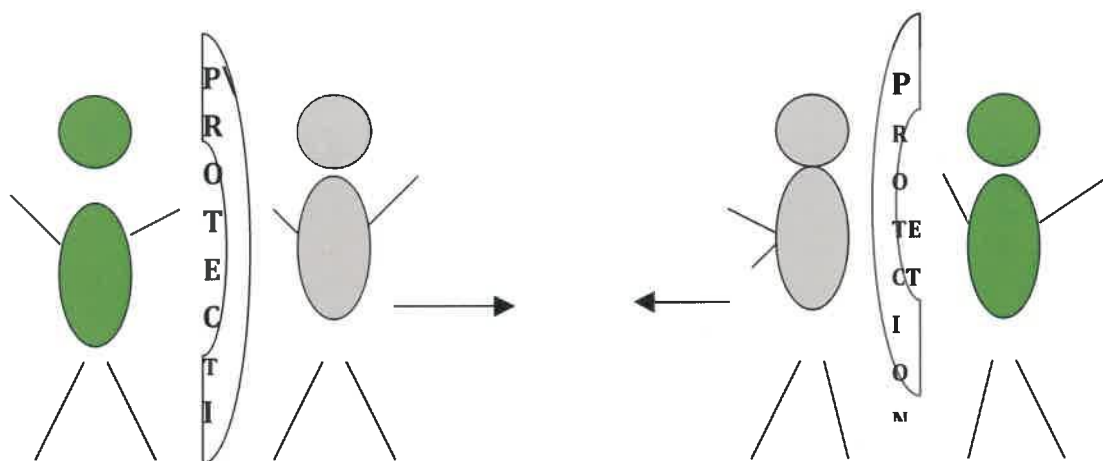
...Persist and Control You

The feelings that control me are:	The feelings that persist in my life are:

Reactions are a cover-up.

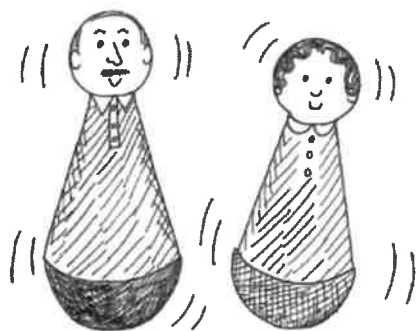
They maintain an illusionary identity, a facsimile

What are clues to know you are in reaction?



Awareness Reactive Self

Reactive Self Awareness



Mom and Dad Game

Find a partner and become your same sex parent (e.g. women become their mother and men become their fathers.)

Become your same sex parent when they were young and then the age they are now (even if they are deceased) talking about Love, Sex, Marriage, Children, Money, Work, Power, Intimacy and Success.

How are you like your parent?

Now switch and become your opposite sex parent. Be that parent while talking about the same issues as before.

-

How are you like your mother? How are you like your father?

Approval and Disapproval Fantasy

What is approval?

What is disapproval?

What is the value of approval or disapproval?

How has it served you? How not?

True Desire

You discover you only have one year to live. What do you want to do before you die?

Eleven months have passed and you only have one month to live. What do you do in this final month? -

You only have one week left. What do you do?

What is stopping you from living like this right now? *

* For our purposes it can't be money.



Memorial Service

Please write your eulogy.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue or grey ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are approximately 20 lines visible. The paper appears to be a standard notebook page.

The Way of Transformation

The man who, being really on the Way, falls upon hard times in the world will not, as a consequence, turn to that friend who offers him refuge and comfort and encourages his old self to survive. Rather, he will seek out someone who will faithfully and inexorably help him to risk himself, so that he may endure the suffering and pass courageously through it, thus making of it a “raft that leads to the far shore.”

Only to the extent that man exposes himself over and over again to annihilation, can that which is indestructible arise within him. In this lies the dignity of daring. Thus, the aim of practice is not to develop an attitude, which allows a man to acquire a state of harmony and peace wherein nothing can ever trouble him. On the contrary, practice should teach him to let himself be assaulted, perturbed, moved, insulted, broken and battered – that is to say, it should enable him to dare to let go his futile hankering after harmony, surcease from pain, and a comfortable life in order that he may discover, in doing battle with the forces that oppose him, that which awaits him beyond the world of opposites.

The first necessity is that we should have the courage to face life, and to encounter all that is most perilous in the world. When this is possible, meditation itself becomes the means by which we accept and welcome the demons which arise from the unconscious – a process very different from the practice of concentration on some object as a protection against such forces. Only if we venture repeatedly through zones of annihilation, can we firm and stable. The more a man learns whole-heartedly to confront the world that threatens him with isolation, the more are the depths of the Ground of Being revealed and the possibilities of new life and Becoming opened.

From the Book, *The Way of Transformation*, by Karlfried Gras von Durkheim



Radical Love ~ What is it? What isn't it?



Judge 'til You Drop

Assignment for Tuesday's call

For the next few days, notice your judgments of yourself and others. As you see patterns, write them down. After you've noticed your judgments and patterns, then ask yourself

- 1) How does this serve me?
- 2) How am I like what I'm judging?
- 3) What would my life be like if these judgments dissolved?

COMMITMENT

Until one is committed
there is hesitancy, the chance to draw back,
always ineffectiveness.

Concerning all acts of initiative (and creation)
there is one elementary truth,
the ignorance of which kills countless ideas
and splendid plans:
that the moment one definitely commits oneself,
then Providence moves too.
All sorts of things occur to help one
that would otherwise never have occurred.
A whole stream of events issues from the decision,
raising in one's favor all manner
of unforeseen incidents and meetings
and material assistance
which no man could have dreamt
would have come his way.
I have learned a deep respect
for one of Goethe's couplets:

*"Whatever you can do, or dream you can...begin it.
Boldness has genius, power and magic in it."*

W.N. Murray, *The Scottish Himalayan Expedition*, 1951